

```
color:#F00;  
}
```

This simple selector targets all instances of the `<a>` element and turns all unvisited links to red. Any visited links will still be purple, as thus far you have not created a selector to override the browser's default visited link style. To show visited links, simply create a selector for the `<a>` element with the `:visited` pseudo class.

```
a:visited {  
color:#999;  
}
```

Now all unvisited links are red, and all visited links will be light gray. It is very important to make visited links appear different from unvisited ones. It is an accepted convention and instantly highlights any links already followed on that machine.

If you are going to have a vast list of links, you need some form of interaction. The user could easily click the wrong link and be taken to the incorrect destination. The answer to this problem is the powerful `:hover` pseudo class, which aside from being a great usability aid can also make the links attractive. Again, the selector first looks for all instances of the `<a>` element, but will only be performed when the user's mouse pointer hovers over the link text.

```
a:hover {  
color:#333;  
}
```

This rule will turn any link text dark gray on mouseover without exception, whether the link is visited or unvisited. The `:active` pseudo class takes care of the link styles when the mouse button is actually clicked, and is another useful usability aid.

```
a:active {  
color: #000;  
}
```

As the user clicks the link, the text will turn black for as long as the current page remains in view, acting as an extra clue to show the user where he or she is about to be taken. After creating your pseudo classes in the order shown previously, you will have the following selectors in the `links.css` style sheet:

```
a:link {  
color:#F00;  
}
```